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## North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

January 6, 2025

Jason Duval  
Sonoma West Holdings  
2064 Gravenstein Highway North  
Sebastopol, CA 95472  
[jason@sonomawestholdings.com](mailto:jason@sonomawestholdings.com)

Dear Mr. Duval:

Subject: Notice of Applicability of General Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, Sonoma West Holdings, Inc., Domestic Wastewater System, Sebastopol, Sonoma County

File: Sonoma West Holdings, Domestic Wastewater Treatment Facility, 2064 Gravenstein Highway North, Sebastopol, WDID No. 1B81202OSON; CIWQS Place ID. 897866

This letter serves as Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject domestic wastewater treatment and disposal system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. This letter also provides transmittal of Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) Order No. R1-2025-0004 for the subject domestic wastewater system, Attachment 2 to this NOA.

Sonoma West Holdings, Inc. (Permittee) submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) on November 15, 2021, to enroll the Sonoma West Holdings (Facility) domestic wastewater treatment facility under the Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order No. WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order). Enrollment under the General Order was initially denied by the Regional Water Board due to compliance issues with the Facility. The Permittee subsequently submitted a Permit Transition Proposal, dated April 4, 2024, and an updated ROWD on October 10, 2024, to address outstanding concerns identified by the Regional Water Board. Based on the information presented in the Permit Transition Proposal and updated ROWD, Regional Water Board staff (Staff) determined this application to be complete in October 2024 and that the domestic wastewater treatment and disposal system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

The Facility is currently authorized to discharge treated domestic wastewaters to land under Waste Discharge Requirements included within National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System (NPDES) Permit No. CA0023655, Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R1-2018-0003. The NPDES Permit also covers industrial process wastewater discharges. The Permittee is no longer discharging industrial process wastewater to surface waters. Because discharges subject to NPDES permitting have ceased, the Permittee is requesting termination of their NPDES Permit and enrollment under the General Order for its domestic wastewater discharges to land, and the Regional Water Board's Winery Beverage and Food Processor General Waste Discharge Requirements (Order No. R1-2016-0002, "WBFP WDR") for its industrial process wastewater discharges to land. Regional Water Board Staff concurs that coverage of the domestic wastewater discharge to land under the General Order, and industrial process wastewater discharges to land under the WBFP General WDR renders the NPDES Permit unnecessary. Accordingly, after public notice and opportunity for comment, Order No. R1-2018-0003 will be proposed for termination at an upcoming Regional Water Board meeting.

A ROWD application fee of \$4,216, that serves as the first annual fee, was received on December 30, 2024. The application fee reflects a Threat to Water Quality and Complexity rating of 3B and a 50 percent fee discount because the authorized discharge is a domestic waste discharge of less than 50,000 gallons per day (gpd).

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all types of domestic wastewater systems and requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Attachment 1 summarizes the operational requirements and the effluent limitations specific to the Sonoma West Holdings domestic wastewater system. The General Order contains additional requirements not summarized in Attachment 1. Additionally, the General Order requires compliance with Regional Water Board Basin Plan water quality objectives. The MRP, Attachment 2, contains the necessary site-specific monitoring and reporting requirements. The Permittee is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

The General Order is available on the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) website at:

[https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board\\_decisions/adopted\\_orders/water\\_quality/2014/wqo2014\\_0153\\_dwq.pdf](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf)

The Regional Water Board Basin Plan, Chapter 3, Water Quality Objectives, is available on the Regional Water Board website at:

[https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water\\_issues/programs/basin\\_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf)

## **Facility and Discharge Description**

The Facility's domestic wastewater treatment system is designed to provide treatment for a peak flow of 6,000 gpd and an average flow of 2,720 gpd, equivalent to a peak employee day of 400 full time employees and an average employee day of 182 employees. Domestic wastewater is collected in four 1,500-gallon septic tanks where settling and anaerobic treatment occurs, and then flows to a lined and aerated domestic wastewater pond. Domestic wastewater is filtered in a sand-media filter and then disinfected with sodium hypochlorite in a chlorine contact tank prior to being applied to Bench No. 1, an approximately 1.8-acre spray field. Domestic tailwater from Bench No. 1 is retained by a constructed berm, which prevents the commingling of domestic and process tailwaters, and is allowed to percolate and evaporate. Commingling of treated domestic wastewater and treated process wastewater is prohibited.

## **California Environmental Quality Act**

As an existing facility, the site is categorically exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 14, section 15301, (ongoing or existing projects), section 15302 (replacement or reconstruction of existing utility systems), and section 15303 (new construction or conversion of small structures).

## **ANNUAL FEES**

The discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Resources Control Board's annual fee schedule for regulated waste discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity, and the treatment technology employed, as defined in the fee schedule listed in California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Waste Discharge Reports and Requirements, Article 1, Fees, Section 2200, Annual Fee Schedules and also available on the [State Water Resources Control Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr) ([https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water\\_quality/#wdr](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr)).

The Fee Schedule is subject to change, and the fee for this Facility may change accordingly. Annual fees are due and payable as invoiced annually to the Permittee by the State Water Board. For more information on fees and answers to frequently asked questions please visit the following website, [https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water\\_quality/#wdr](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr)

Questions or concerns about this NOA letter, or related matters, should be directed to Rachel Prat at (707) 576-2542 or [Rachel.Prat@waterboards.ca.gov](mailto:Rachel.Prat@waterboards.ca.gov).

Sincerely,

Valerie Quinto  
Executive Officer

250106\_MTH\_SonomaWest\_SDS\_NOA

Attachments:

1. Summary of WWTS Specific General Order Requirements
2. Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R1-2025-0004

cc: Julian Kayne, Sr. Associate Engineer, Kennedy Jenks,  
[juliankayne@kennedyjenks.com](mailto:juliankayne@kennedyjenks.com)

## Attachment 1 - Summary of System Specific General Order<sup>1</sup>

| General Order Section | Initial Page | Numeric Limitation | Requirement (refer to General Order for details) |
|-----------------------|--------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
|-----------------------|--------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------|

### A. PROHIBITIONS

|          |    |    |              |
|----------|----|----|--------------|
| A.1-A.11 | 15 | -- | Prohibitions |
|----------|----|----|--------------|

### B. REQUIREMENTS BY WASTEWATER SYSTEM TYPE

|             |    |                                         |                                                |
|-------------|----|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| B.1.a-B.1.i | 16 | --                                      | All Wastewater Systems                         |
| B.1.b       | 16 | 6,000 gpd (peak)<br>2,720 gpd (average) | Wastewater Flow Limit                          |
| B.2.a-B.2.e | 20 | --                                      | Septic Systems                                 |
| B.5.a-B.5.f | 23 | --                                      | Pond Systems                                   |
| B.7.a-B.7.h | 26 | --                                      | Land Application and/or Recycled Water Systems |
| B.8.a-B.8.f | 26 | --                                      | Sludge/Solids/Biosolids Disposal               |

### C. GROUNDWATER AND SURFACE WATER LIMITATIONS

|     |    |    |                                           |
|-----|----|----|-------------------------------------------|
| C.1 | 27 | -- | Groundwater and Surface Water Limitations |
|-----|----|----|-------------------------------------------|

### D. EFFLUENT LIMITATIONS

|       |    |                |                                         |
|-------|----|----------------|-----------------------------------------|
| D.1.a | 27 | 90 mg/l        | Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD) maximum |
| D.1.a | 27 | Not Applicable | Total Suspended Solids (TSS)            |

### E. PROVISIONS

|                                                                   |    |                                                                                |                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Technical Report Requirements (within 90 days of issuance of NOA) |    |                                                                                |                                              |
| E.1.a                                                             | 28 | Have on-site.                                                                  | Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan |
| E.1.b                                                             | 29 | Have on-site.                                                                  | Sampling and Analysis Plan                   |
| E.1.c                                                             | 30 | Submit to Regional Water Board within 90 days issuance of NOA.<br>Have on-site | Sludge Management Plan                       |
| E.2.h                                                             | 32 | Have on-site                                                                   | Copy of NOA, and General Order               |

241218\_Attachment\_1\_SonomaWest\_NOA

<sup>1</sup> The General Order is available on the [State Water Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) at:  
[https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board\\_decisions/adopted\\_orders/water\\_quality/2014/wqo2014\\_0153\\_dwq.pdf](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf)

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## North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

### California Regional Water Quality Control Board North Coast Region

#### **MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM** **Order No. R1-2025-0004**

For

**Sonoma West Holdings, Plant No. 2**  
**Domestic Wastewater Treatment System**  
**2064 Gravenstein Highway North**  
**Sebastopol, CA 95472**  
**WDID No. 1B812020SON**

**Sonoma County**

This Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) describes requirements for monitoring a wastewater treatment system. California Water Code (Water Code) section 13267 authorizes the Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) to require technical and monitoring reports. This MRP establishes monitoring and reporting requirements, which implement California regulations.

Sonoma West Holdings, Inc. (Permittee) owns and operates a domestic wastewater treatment and disposal system that is subject to the Notice of Applicability (NOA) of General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order). The reports required by the MRP are necessary to ensure the Permittee complies with the NOA and General Order.

#### **I. GENERAL MONITORING PROVISIONS**

- A.** If the Permittee monitors any pollutant more frequently than required by this MRP, using test procedures as specified in this MRP, the results of this monitoring shall be included in the calculation and reporting of the data submitted in the quarterly and annual self-monitoring reports.
- B.** Analysis of monitoring samples shall be performed by Laboratories certified by the State Water Resources Control Board, Division of Drinking Water, in accordance with the provision of Water Code section 13176, and must include quality assurance/quality control data with their reports.

- C. Compliance and monitoring analyses shall be conducted using commercially available and reasonably achievable detection limits that are lower than the applicable effluent limitation. If no minimum level (ML) value is below the effluent limitation, the lowest ML shall be selected as the reporting level (RL).

## II. MONITORING LOCATIONS

The Permittee shall establish the following monitoring locations to demonstrate compliance with the discharge prohibitions, discharge specifications, and other requirements in this Order:

**Table 1. Monitoring Station Locations**

| Monitoring Location Name | Monitoring Location Description                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| INF-003                  | Influent Domestic Wastewater from the Influent Lift Station located between the Septic Tanks and the Domestic Wastewater Treatment Pond. |
| PND-001                  | Aerated Domestic Wastewater Treatment Pond                                                                                               |
| REC-001                  | Effluent sampling port located between the Chlorine Contact Tank and Domestic Effluent Spray field.                                      |
| BENCH 1                  | Visual observation of the Domestic Effluent Spray Field.                                                                                 |

## III. SEPTIC TANK MONITORING

- A. Septic Tanks shall be inspected and/or pumped at least as frequently as described below. Inspection of sludge and scum depth are not required if the tanks are pumped at least annually.

**Table 2. Septic Tank Monitoring**

| Parameter                                                         | Units  | Sample Type | Inspection Frequency |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------|----------------------|
| Sludge depth and scum thickness in each compartment of each tank  | Feet   | Staff Gauge | Annually             |
| Distance between bottom of scum layer and bottom of outlet device | Inches | Staff Gauge | Annually             |
| Distance between top of sludge layer and bottom of outlet device  | Inches | Staff Gauge | Annually             |
| Effluent filter condition (clean as needed)                       | --     | --          | Annually             |

- B. Septic tanks shall be pumped when any one of the following conditions exist:

- The combined thickness of sludge and scum exceed one-third of the tank depth of the first compartment.

- b. The scum layer is within 3 inches of the outlet device.
  - c. The sludge layer is within 8 inches of the outlet device.
- C.** If the septic tank is pumped during the year, the pumping report shall be submitted with the annual report. All pumping reports shall be submitted with the next regularly scheduled monitoring report. At a minimum, the record shall include the date, nature of service, service company name, and service company license number.

#### **IV. POND SYSTEM MONITORING**

- A.** The Permittee shall monitor influent flow to the domestic wastewater treatment system at Monitoring Location INF-003 as follows:

**Table 3. Influent Monitoring**

| Parameter                                                                                                         | Units                 | Sample Type | Monitoring Frequency |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------|----------------------|
| Average Daily Flow                                                                                                | Gallons per day (gpd) | Meter       | Daily <sup>(1)</sup> |
| Table Notes:<br>1. Daily flows are to be collected on each weekday, during normal business hours of the Facility. |                       |             |                      |

- B.** The Permittee shall monitor the domestic wastewater treatment pond, at Monitoring Location PND-001, as follows:

**Table 4. Wastewater Treatment Pond Monitoring**

| Parameter        | Units    | Sample Type | Inspection Frequency |
|------------------|----------|-------------|----------------------|
| Dissolved Oxygen | mg/L     | Grab        | Monthly              |
| Freeboard        | 0.1 feet | Measurement | Monthly              |
| Odors            | --       | Observation | Monthly              |
| Berm Condition   | --       | Observation | Monthly              |

- C.** The Permittee shall monitor the treated domestic wastewater from the domestic wastewater treatment system at monitoring location REC-001 as follows:

**Table 5. Effluent Monitoring**

| Parameter                 | Units | Sample Type | Monitoring Frequency | Required Analytical Test Method <sup>(1)</sup> |
|---------------------------|-------|-------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Biochemical Oxygen Demand | mg/L  | Grab        | Monthly              | Standard Methods                               |
| Total Suspended Solids    | mg/L  | Grab        | Monthly              | Standard Methods                               |



|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |            |      |         |                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------|---------|------------------|
| Nitrate (as N)                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | mg/L       | Grab | Monthly | Standard Methods |
| Total Dissolved Solids                                                                                                                                                                                                           | mg/L       | Grab | Monthly | Standard Methods |
| Chloride                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | mg/L       | Grab | Monthly | Standard Methods |
| Total Coliform Organisms                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MPN/100 mL | Grab | Weekly  | Standard Methods |
| <b>Table Notes:</b><br>1. In accordance with the current edition of Standard Methods for Examination of Water and Wastewater (American Public Health Administration) or current test procedures specified in 40 C.F.R. part 136. |            |      |         |                  |

## V. LAND APPLICATION AREA MONITORING

The Permittee shall monitor the operation of and discharge to the surface disposal irrigation field at Monitoring Location BENCH 1 as follows:

**Table 6. Surface Disposal Irrigation Field Monitoring**

| Parameter                                                                                                                | Units             | Sample Type                    | Monitoring Frequency |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------|
| Wastewater Flow                                                                                                          | gpd               | Meter                          | Daily                |
| Local Rainfall                                                                                                           | Inches            | Weather Station <sup>(1)</sup> | Monthly              |
| Acreage Applied                                                                                                          | Acres             | Calculated                     | Monthly              |
| Application Rate                                                                                                         | Gallon/acre/month | Calculated                     | Monthly              |
| Soil Erosion Evidence                                                                                                    | --                | Observation                    | Monthly              |
| Containment Berm Condition                                                                                               | --                | Observation                    | Monthly              |
| Soil Saturation/Ponding                                                                                                  | --                | Observation                    | Monthly              |
| Nuisance Odors/Vectors                                                                                                   | --                | Observation                    | Monthly              |
| Discharge Off-Site                                                                                                       | --                | Observation                    | Monthly              |
| <b>Table Notes:</b><br>1. Weather station may be site-specific station or nearby governmental weather reporting station. |                   |                                |                      |

## VI. SOLIDS DISPOSAL MONITORING

The Permittee shall report the handling and disposal of all solids (e.g., screenings, grit, sludge, biosolids, etc.) generated at the wastewater system. Records shall include the name/contact information for the hauling company, the type and amount of waste transported, the date removed from the wastewater system, the disposal facility name and address, and copies of analytical data required by the entity accepting the waste. These records shall be submitted as part of the annual monitoring report.

## VII. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

### A. Quarterly Monitoring Reports

Quarterly reports shall be submitted to the Regional Water Board on the first day of the second month after the quarter ends, as follows:

**Table 7. Monitoring Periods and Reporting Schedule**

| Report          | Reporting Period         | Report Due Date |
|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
| 1st Quarter SMR | January through March    | May 1st         |
| 2nd Quarter SMR | April through June       | August 1st      |
| 3rd Quarter SMR | July through September   | November 1st    |
| 4th Quarter SMR | October through December | February 1st    |

The reports shall bear the certification and signature of the Discharger's authorized representative. At a minimum, the quarterly reports shall include:

1. Results of all required monitoring.
2. A comparison of monitoring data to the discharge specifications, applicable effluent limits, disclosure of any violations of the NOA and/or General Order, and an explanation of any violation of those requirements. (Data shall be presented in tabular format.)
3. Copies of laboratory analytical report(s) and chain of custody form(s).

### B. Annual Report

Annual Reports shall be submitted to the Regional Water Board by **March 1st following the monitoring year**. The Annual Report shall include the following:

1. Tabular and graphical summaries of all monitoring data collected during the year.
2. An evaluation of the performance of the wastewater treatment facility, including discussion of capacity issues, nuisance conditions, system problems, and a forecast of the flows anticipated in the next year. A flow rate evaluation as described in the General Order (Provision E.2.c) shall also be submitted.
3. A discussion of compliance and the corrective action taken, as well as any planned or proposed actions needed to bring the discharge into compliance with the NOA and/or General Order.
4. A discussion of any data gaps and potential deficiencies/redundancies in the monitoring system or reporting program.

5. The name and contact information for the wastewater operator responsible for operation, maintenance, and system monitoring.

**C. Electronic Submittal of Documents**

All monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Water Board via e-mail to [NorthCoast@waterboards.ca.gov](mailto:NorthCoast@waterboards.ca.gov) or on disk (CD or DVD) in a Portable Document Format (PDF) file in lieu of paper-sourced documents. The guidelines for electronic submittal of documents can be found on the Regional Water Board website at: <http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast>.

At any time during the term of this permit, the Regional Water Board may notify the Permittee to electronically submit both technical and Self-Monitoring Reports (SMRs) to the State Water Board's GeoTracker database in searchable Portable Document Format (pdf). In addition, analytical data will be required to be uploaded to the GeoTracker database under a site-specific global identification number that will be assigned to the Permittee. Information on the GeoTracker database is provided on the State Water Board website at: [https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/data\\_databases/groundwater.shtml](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/data_databases/groundwater.shtml)

**D. Transmittal Letter**

A transmittal letter, identifying the facility name, address and WDID number shall accompany each monitoring report. The transmittal letter shall discuss any violations that occurred during the reporting period and all actions taken or planned for correcting the violations, such as operation or system modifications. If the Permittee previously submitted to the Regional Water Board a report describing the corrective action or time schedule for implementing the corrective actions, reference to the previous report is satisfactory.

**E. Signature and Certification**

All monitoring report shall be signed by a person described in subsection 66270.11 (a) of Title 22, Division 4.5, Chapter 20, Article 2 of the California Code of Regulations (CCR) or a duly authorized representative of that person as per subsection 66270.11(b) of Title 22, Division 4.5, Chapter 20, Article 2 of the CCR. The person signing the reports shall make the following certification:

"I certify under penalty of law that this document and all attachments were prepared under my direction or supervision in accordance with a system designed to assure that qualified personnel properly gather and evaluate the information submitted. Based on my inquiry of the person or persons who manage the system or those persons directly responsible for gathering the information, the information submitted is, to the best of my knowledge and belief, true, accurate, and complete. I am aware that there are significant penalties for submitting false information, including the possibility of fine and imprisonment for knowing violations."

**F. Spills and Unauthorized Discharges Notification**

Information regarding all spills and unauthorized discharges that may endanger health or the environment shall be provided orally to the Regional Water Board<sup>1</sup> within 24 hours from the time the Permittee becomes aware of the circumstances and a written report shall also be provided within ten (10) days of the time the discharge.

Information to be provided verbally to the Regional Water Board includes:

1. Name and contact information of caller;
2. Date, time and location of spill occurrence;
3. Estimates of spill volume, rate of flow, and spill duration, if available and reasonably accurate;
4. Surface water bodies impacted, if any;
5. Any adverse impacts observed, if any;
6. Cause of spill, if known at the time of the notification;
7. Cleanup actions taken or repairs made at the time of the notification; and Responding agencies.

Ordered By: \_\_\_\_\_

Valerie Quinto  
Executive Officer

250106\_MTH\_SonomaWest\_MRP

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<sup>1</sup> The contact number of the Regional Water Board during normal business hours is (707) 576-2220. After normal business hours, spill reporting to the State Warning Center will satisfy the 24-hour spill reporting requirement for the Regional Water Board. The contact number for spill reporting for the State Warning Center is (800) 852-7550.